

Time Off and Leave Policy

Policy number: POL-HR-002 **Owner:** Sofia Marques, Head of People **Effective date:** 1 January 2026

1. Purpose

Rest matters. This policy explains how much paid time off Northwind Labs employees receive, how to request it and how other types of leave work. Where local law in Portugal, Germany, Poland or the United States gives more generous rights, local law applies.

2. Requesting time off

- All time off is requested and approved in **Workday** under "Request Absence".
- Give at least **two weeks' notice** for absences of three days or more, and at least one working day for single days.
- Add your absence to your Google Calendar as "Out of office" so meetings are declined automatically, and set a Slack status.
- Managers approve or reject requests within five working days. Overlapping requests in a small team are approved first come, first served.

3. Annual vacation allowance

Every full-time employee receives paid vacation days based on their length of service on 1 January of each year. Part-time employees receive a pro-rated allowance.

Length of service	Vacation days per year
Less than 3 years	25 working days
3 to 5 years	27 working days
More than 5 years	30 working days

Public holidays are not deducted from the vacation allowance. Each office observes the public holidays listed in the Holidays Calendar 2026 in the handbook; remote employees follow the holidays of the country in their employment contract.

New joiners receive a pro-rated allowance for their first calendar year, rounded up to the nearest half day.

4. Carry-over

Up to **5 unused vacation days** may be carried over to the next calendar year. Carried-over days must be used by **31 March**; after that date they expire. Where local law requires a longer carry-over period (for example, after long-term sickness or parental leave), local law applies. Vacation days are not paid out in exchange for money except on termination of employment where the law requires it.

5. Company-wide rest days

In addition to public holidays, all offices close on **Northwind Day** (18 September, the anniversary of the company's founding) and between 24 December and 1 January. Days of the year-end closure that are not public holidays are given as extra paid days and are not taken from your vacation allowance.

6. Sick leave

- Tell your manager and the People team (Slack #people-help or people@northwind.example) on the first day of absence, before 10:00 local time if possible.
- A medical certificate is required from the **fourth consecutive calendar day** of sickness in Portugal, Germany and Poland, and from the sixth working day in the US.
- Record the absence in Workday as "Sick leave" when you are back.
- Sick days never reduce your vacation allowance. If you fall ill during vacation and provide a medical certificate, those days are returned to you.

7. Other types of leave

Leave type	Paid days	Notes
Wedding or civil partnership (own)	5	Within 3 months of the event
Bereavement, close family	5	Partner, child, parent, sibling
Bereavement, extended family	2	Grandparents, in-laws
Moving house	1	Once per calendar year
Volunteering	2	With a registered charity
Jury or civic duty	As required	Bring the official summons

Parental leave (birth, adoption and surrogacy) is described in the Parental Leave Summary in the handbook. Unpaid leave of up to 3 months can be requested after 2 years of service; it needs approval from your department VP and the Head of People.

8. Sabbatical

After 5 years of continuous service, employees may take a paid sabbatical of **4 consecutive weeks** in addition to their regular vacation. The sabbatical must be taken within 2 years of becoming eligible and must be agreed with your manager at least 3 months in advance.

9. Recording and reporting

Managers can see their team's absence calendar in Workday. Absence data is used only for planning and payroll and is handled according to the Information Security Policy (Restricted data, POL-SEC-009).

10. Contacts

- Questions about your balance: Workday, "My Time Off"
- Questions about this policy: Slack #people-help
- Policy owner: Sofia Marques, Head of People